HUNT

WPCMON.EXE APPDATA EXECUTION

Hunt for a legitimate Windows binary executed from a user-writable location observed in DLL sideloading incidents.

CLASSIFICATION

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch. Confidence Medium. Behavioral placement signal.

PRIMARY PLATFORM

Microsoft Defender XDR. Required telemetry: DeviceProcessEvents.

OPERATIONAL VALUE 8/10

Relocated signed utilities in AppData are uncommon and investigable, but benign packaging and forensic copies must be measured.

Executive Assessment

Facts, interpretation and explicit boundaries

SOURCE FACT

Huntress observed several September-October incidents where CMS.exe activity preceded rs.win32.exe and WpcMon.exe execution from AppData.

SOURCE FACT

The AppData copy of WpcMon.exe loaded modified IPHLPAPI.DLL or samcli.dll and a Run key referenced the relocated executable.

ANALYST INFERENCE

WpcMon.exe process execution from AppData is a useful prevalence hunt. It is narrower and more durable than the campaign IP, but not conclusive.

UNCONFIRMED BY QUERY

Adjacent DLL load, Microsoft signature, camera-software initial access, persistence, successful beaconing and campaign attribution.

Observed Attack Flow

Only stages directly supported by Huntress

1

Initial access context

Multiple incidents originated from camera management software identified as CMS.exe.

2

Remote component

rs.win32.exe executed from AppData\Roaming\CMS\RemoteSetup with remote-control arguments.

3

Relocated utility

Legitimate WpcMon.exe was placed under AppData\Local\Microsoft\WpcMon.

4

DLL sideloading

The relocated binary loaded modified IPHLPAPI.DLL or samcli.dll.

5

Persistence and C2

A user Run key referenced WpcMon.exe and modified DLLs beaconed externally.

BOUNDARY

The query implements only the relocated WpcMon.exe execution signal.

Telemetry & Fields

Documented Defender XDR process-event schema

DeviceProcessEvents	**Required**	Process creation telemetry
FileName	**Required**	WpcMon.exe identity
FolderPath	**Required**	AppData placement
SHA1	**Enrichment**	Stable file pivot when present
ProcessCommandLine	**Enrichment**	Created-process arguments
InitiatingProcess*	**Enrichment**	Parent context
ProcessUniqueId	**Enrichment**	Strong process correlation key

UNAVAILABLE FROM THIS QUERY

Created-file signature state and proof that a malicious DLL was loaded. Validate with DeviceFileCertificateInfo and DeviceImageLoadEvents separately.

Primary Hunting Query

Microsoft Defender XDR - process placement signal

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where FileName =~ "WpcMon.exe"
| where FolderPath contains @"\AppData\"
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, AccountName,
          FileName, FolderPath, SHA1, ProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessFolderPath,
          InitiatingProcessCommandLine, ProcessId,
          InitiatingProcessId, ProcessUniqueId,
          InitiatingProcessUniqueId, ReportId
| order by Timestamp desc
```

CONDITION EVIDENCE

Huntress observed WpcMon.exe from AppData. FileName and FolderPath are documented DeviceProcessEvents fields. No hash, C2, parent, threshold or rarity condition is imposed.

STATUS

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch. Do not alert until benign overlap and file provenance are measured.

Cross-SIEM Assessment

No mechanical translations

SPLUNK

No reliable implementation can currently be written. Required: endpoint process telemetry, index, sourcetype, parser and verified process path fields.

CHRONICLE YARA-L 2.0

No reliable implementation can currently be written. Required: parser name and verified UDM mapping for target process file name, full path and parent context.

MICROSOFT SENTINEL

The selected schema is Defender XDR advanced hunting, not Log Analytics DeviceProcessEvents by assumption. Use the Defender portal or verify connector-specific table availability.

EVIDENCE TO COLLECT

Representative legitimate WpcMon.exe executions, relocated binaries from software packaging, signature/certificate state and adjacent image-load events.

Validation & Tuning Plan

Promotion requires provenance and overlap measurements

01 Run the hunt over available retention and inspect every unique FolderPath.

02 For each result, pivot on SHA1 and verify signature/trust using DeviceFileCertificateInfo.

03 Inspect DeviceImageLoadEvents for co-located IPHLPAPI.DLL, samcli.dll or other unexpected modules.

04 Review parent process, Run-key evidence, outbound connections and authorized software inventory.

05 Reject alert promotion if legitimate packaging or support tooling commonly runs WpcMon.exe from AppData.

SUCCESS CRITERION

AppData execution is absent or rare in the environment and suspicious samples show unapproved provenance or co-located module loading.

ATT&CK, Conclusion & References

Evidence-backed scope and publication record

MITRE ATT&CK T1574.002 / T1547.001

DLL Side-Loading and Registry Run Keys are directly supported by the observed incident chain; the query itself hunts only process placement.

CONCLUSION

The AppData WpcMon.exe signal is suitable for hunting, not a standalone alert. Corroborate with signature, module-load, registry and network evidence.

PRIMARY RESEARCH

Huntress. Camera Management Software Compromise Leads to Malware Deployment. 27 October 2026.

hxxps://www[.]huntress[.]com/blog/camera-management-software-compromise-malware

OFFICIAL SCHEMA

Microsoft Learn. DeviceProcessEvents advanced hunting table.

hxxps://learn[.]microsoft[.]com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-deviceprocessevents-table

QUALITY CONTROLS

Eight A4 pages; no arbitrary threshold; no customer data; links defanged; no invented cross-SIEM mappings.